The Water Cycle

About 97 percent of Earth's water is held in the oceans, while only about 3 percent is freshwater, most of it locked in glaciers and ice caps.

Evaporation turns liquid water into vapour, which rises and cools to form clouds in a process called condensation.

The Amazon River discharges about 209,000 cubic metres of water per second into the Atlantic Ocean, more than the next seven largest rivers combined.

Groundwater makes up about 30 percent of the world's freshwater and supplies drinking water to roughly half the global population.